



SHORTED OUT

A TWO-AND-HALF year old boy at a convention of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh in Allahabad seems to be more suited to the organisation's famous uniform than those around him.



A GERMAN COUPLE WHOSE SURROGATE TWINS WERE BORN IN INDIA ARE TOLD THEIR CHILDREN CANNOT BE CITIZENS IN EITHER.

GUJARAT | Identity Crisis

It must be among the more twisted tales of the globalised world. Germans Jan and Suzanne Balaz are fighting for the citizenship rights of their surrogate twins. The childless couple sought help at Dr Naina Patel's Akansha IV Fertility Clinic at Anand, Gujarat, and became parents in January 2008. After their twins were born, the Balazs joy was short-lived when they realised that their children could not be legitimate citizens in either countries. German law does not recognise children delivered through surrogacy. Indian law will not grant citizenship to the twins either. A Gujarat High Court ruling that the twins should get Indian citizenship was challenged by the Indian Government in the Supreme Court. Rather than be united in joy, the family stays separated: Suzanne in Germany earning a living and her husband in Jaipur with his sons, fighting the legal battle. There was some relief last week when the German Government said the male twins could get a one-time visa.

by Uday Mahurkar